NEPQ Phase 5 — Commitment

Cheat sheet · 5 Nov 2026

Purpose

Get the prospect to say, **in their own words**, that they want to act **now**, not "some day". It's short, but it turns "that would be nice" into "I'm ready".

Do / Don't

Do	Don't
Ask them to confirm they want to change	Assume a nod means yes
Gently push back: "Why now, not later?"	Pressure them or argue
Use a calm, curious, slightly puzzled tone	Sound scripted or challenging
Let them justify it to themselves	Supply the reasons for them

The question flow

Step	Example question
1. Confirm	"So is this something you actually want to sort out?"
2. Push back	"Why now, though? Why not just leave it a few more months?"
3. Their reason	"What makes it important to fix now rather than later?"
4. Reaffirm	"So it sounds like you're ready to do something about it?"

Why it works: once people say out loud that they want to act now, they want their actions to match their words (congruence). The pushback isn't to discourage them; it makes them argue *for* the change.

Tone is everything: the same pushback line can sound helpful or hostile. Say it softly, with genuine curiosity, never as a challenge.

Applied to TRB: gym owners

Two situations, depending on where you are:

A. Discovery stage (now, during your 20 conversations). Nothing to sell yet. The commitment is to **try a fix** if you build it. That is your real validation test.

Step	Discovery version
Confirm	"Is [their pain] something you'd actually want fixed, or just something you live with?"
Push back	"Plenty of gyms just put up with it. Why not leave it?"
Their reason	"What makes it worth fixing for you?"
Commit	"If I built something that did [their ideal fix], would you try it for a month?"

B. Offer stage (once you have a product). The commitment is to start the trial or book the setup session.

Step	Offer version
Confirm	"So getting this sorted is something you want to do?"
Push back	"Why now, though, and not after January?"
Their reason	Let them answer fully. Don't fill the silence.
Next step	"Want to book the setup session? When suits you this week?"

Log it: a clear "yes, I'd try it" is the same as ticking **"would pay / switch"** in your CRM Pains tab. Your aim from the 20 conversations is 3 to 5 of those yeses on the same pain.

Self-check after each call

☐ Did they say they want to fix it, in their own words?

☐ Did I push back softly, and did they defend acting now?

☐ Did they give their own reason, not mine?

☐ Did I get a clear yes or no to a next step?

Next phase: Consequences, meaning the cost of acting compared with not acting.